

3 Changing ecosystems

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KNOWLEDGE FOCUS

You will answer questions on:

- 3.1 Characteristics of the Antarctic ecosystem
- 3.2 Threats to the Antarctic ecosystem and how they can be managed
- 3.3 Characteristics of the tropical rainforest ecosystem
- 3.4 Threats to tropical rainforest ecosystems and how they can be managed

EXAM SKILLS FOCUS

In this topic you will:

- show that you understand the command word 'sketch' and answer a 'sketch' question
- show that you understand the command word 'discuss' and answer a 'discuss' question
- show that you understand the differences between question types.

The command word 'sketch' requires you to make a simple freehand drawing showing the key features, taking care over proportions. When answering 'sketch' questions, it is important to be clear and accurate, even if the drawing is not highly detailed or very artistic.

The command word 'discuss' means to write about issue(s) or topic(s) in depth in a structured way. When responding to 'discuss' questions, it is important to examine different viewpoints, provide evidence to support your reasoning and reach a reasoned conclusion.

Understanding question types involves identifying the format of the question, such as multiple-choice, short response, long response or gap fill, and knowing what kind of answer each type requires. Recognising the type of question helps you structure your response and ensure that you provide the right amount of detail.